

and its component units. Three separately chartered legal entities, whose activities are related to those of the University and whose primary purpose is to provide financial assistance and other support to the University and its education program, are discretely presented as component units of the University. These include the University of South Carolina Development Foundation; the University of South Carolina Educational Foundation; and the University of South Carolina Business Partnership Foundation. Because the activities and resources of these entities are significant, provide a direct benefit, and are accessible to the University, they are considered component units of the University and are discretely presented in the University's financial statements. All discretely presented component units are audited annually by a public accounting firm. All audit reports are available for public inspection.

The University conducts business under a comprehensive set of policies and procedures to improve communication, promote administrative consistency and efficiency and ensure compliance with pertinent state and federal laws as well as state and regional accreditation requirements. Financial policies are in place for University accounting to include revenue and expenditures, contract and grant accounting, tuition and fee assessment, payroll, and capital debt. Following the implementation of new administrative finance systems, policies have been updated to conform to revised practices.

The University is responsible for controlling its budget and using the funds to fulfill its educational, research and public service missions. It is also responsible for planning, developing, and controlling budgets and expenditures within authorized allocations in accordance with University, state and federal policies and procedures. The University maintains budgetary controls to ensure compliance with provisions embodied in the annual appropriated budget approved by the South Carolina General Assembly, and as further directed by the Board of Trustees.

Economic Condition

The economic position of the University remains robust evidenced by consistent operating revenue growth, strong demand for enrollment, and stable, manageable changes in operating expenditures. As a state-supported higher education institution, the University's economic position is closely tied to the State of South Carolina. The State finished the 2024 fiscal year on a positive note with full funding of the State's Rainy-Day Fund at 5.5 percent of the prior year's General Fund Revenues and fully funded the Capital Reserve Account at 3 percent of the prior year's General Fund Revenues.

South Carolina's unemployment rate was 3.6 percent at the end of June 2024, which was 0.5 percent higher than June 2023. The national average was 4.1 percent and South Carolina ranked 23rd, compared to other states, per the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. According to the Economic Outlook, published by the South Carolina Department of Commerce, trends in non-farm jobs continue to be positive for the state with the most recent increase in June totaling 8,500, with the largest gains in leisure and hospitality services and trade, transportation, and utilities.

University Highlights

The 2023-2024 academic and fiscal year was another productive year for University. The University's overall financial position remains strong and stable. The University once again raised the bar in admissions, enrollment, research, graduation, and retention rates.

For fiscal year 2024, the University has received additional state funding to support academic initiatives that promote access and affordability through tuition mitigation for residents of South Carolina and continued funding to support the maintenance and capital needs of our campuses. The University relies on tuition and fees to support the general operating budget and with added state support for fiscal year 2025 the University has been able to mitigate tuition increases for 2025.

Student interest in the University remains strong and demand for enrollment continues to grow, with a record number 52,708 applications received for the Fall 2024 freshman class, an increase of 13% over last year's record. Preliminary data indicates approximately 9,200 new undergraduate students on the Columbia campus, of which 7,290 are new freshmen, the second largest freshman class in University history. Student success is also at an all-time high, with a freshman to sophomore retention rate climbing to 92% for the first time. As a result of these gains, overall enrollment for the Columbia campus stands at 38,353, the highest ever in University history, and for the University System at 55,332. Both are increases of over 5% from last Fall 2023's record enrollment highs for Columbia and the USC System.

The University is classified as an R1 University by the Carnegie Classification for Institutions of Higher Education. Research grant awards were \$309.4 million in the 2024 fiscal year. Awards in fiscal year 2025 are up 4% to date and are estimated to surpass 2024.

Awards and Acknowledgements

The Government Finance Officers Association of the United States and Canada (GFOA) awarded a Certificate of Achievement for Excellence in Financial Reporting to the University for its Annual Comprehensive Financial Report for the fiscal year ended June 30, 2023. This was the thirteenth consecutive year that the University has been honored with this prestigious award. To receive a Certificate of Achievement, a government unit must publish an easily readable and efficiently organized Annual Comprehensive Financial Report. This report must satisfy both generally accepted accounting principles and applicable legal requirements. A Certificate of Achievement is valid for one year. We believe our current Annual Comprehensive Financial Report continues to meet the Certificate of Achievement Program's requirements, and we are submitting it to the GFOA to determine its eligibility for another certificate.

Preparation of this Annual Comprehensive Financial Report in a timely manner would not have been possible without the efforts of the University Controller's Office and the coordinated efforts of the University community and all campuses, with special assistance from the Office of Research, Assessment and Analytics, Student Affairs, Enrollment Management,

University Athletics, Sponsored Awards Management, Bursar's Office, Office of Financial Aid and University Communications. In addition, the Office of the State Auditor, the State Comptroller General's Office, and the Office of the State Treasurer provided invaluable assistance.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "Edward L. Walton".

Mr. Edward L. Walton
Executive Vice President for Administration
& Chief Financial Officer

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "Mandy M. Kibler".

Ms. Mandy M. Kibler
Associate Vice President for
Administration and Finance
& University Controller



Government Finance Officers Association

**Certificate of
Achievement
for Excellence
in Financial
Reporting**

Presented to

University of South Carolina

For its Annual Comprehensive
Financial Report
For the Fiscal Year Ended

June 30, 2023

Executive Director/CEO

UNIVERSITY OF
South Carolina
Board of Trustees



Thad H. Westbrook
Chair
11th Judicial Circuit
Attorney
Term: 2023-2026



Rose Buyck Newton
Vice Chair
14th Judicial Circuit
Banker
Term: 2020-2024



C. Dan Adams
Governor's Designee
Investment Banker
Term: Appointment



Alex English
5th Judicial Circuit
Retired
Term: 2023-2026



C. Edward Floyd, M.D.
12th Judicial Circuit
Surgeon
Term: 2023-2026



Brian C. Harlan
8th Judicial Circuit
Chief Executive Officer
Term: 2020-2024



Henry L. Jolly Jr., D.M.D.
7th Judicial Circuit
Dentist
Term: 2023-2026



Richard A. Jones, Jr.
Governor's Appointee
Attorney
Term: Appointment



Hubert F. "Hugh" Mobley
6th Judicial Circuit
Pharmacist
Term: 2020-2024



Elizabeth Scott Moise
USC Alumni Association
Attorney
Term: 2022-2024



Leah B. Moody
16th Judicial Circuit
Attorney
Term: 2020-2024



Emma W. Morris
10th Judicial Circuit
Attorney
Term: 2020-2024



Reid T. Sherard
13th Judicial Circuit
Attorney
Term: 2023-2026



C. Dorn Smith, III M.D.
Chair Emeritus
3rd Judicial Circuit
Physician
Term: 2023-2026



John C. von Lehe, Jr.
9th Judicial Circuit
Attorney
Term: 2023-2026



Charles H. Williams, II
1st Judicial Circuit
Attorney
Term: 2023-2026



Vacant
2nd Judicial Circuit



Vacant
4th Judicial Circuit



Vacant
15th Judicial Circuit



Ellen Weaver
State Superintendent of
Education



Cameron Howell
Secretary of the Board



Henry McMaster
Governor
State of South Carolina



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    P --> CS[Chief of Staff S. Fritz]
    P --> GC[General Counsel Executive Dir of Compliance Programs W. Parham]
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